What's Been Sent, What's Been Asked For

A worksheet for keeping track of Mom's Medicaid application, in your own words.

Letters about Mom's application arrive in the same stack as the rehab paperwork and the pharmacy receipts. This worksheet gives them a page of their own.

Copy what the papers say, with the dates printed on them. Don't work out what a letter means or when a reply is due; write what it says and who you'll show it to. If nothing has been sent yet, write “nothing sent yet” in the second box and fill in the rest as it happens.

Where things stand today

One or two lines, as you understand it: not started, being put together, sent, or waiting on something. Add who told you and when.

FOR EXAMPLE Being put together. The applications specialist has the bank statements and is waiting for the pension letter. From Tuesday's call.

What has been sent, and when

What went in, the date, how it was sent and who sent it. Then where the proof of submission and the copies are kept, and the case or application number if you've been given one.

FOR EXAMPLE Application submitted online on the 3rd by the applications specialist. We have the confirmation page and a full copy. Both are in the blue folder.

Letters and calls from the Medicaid agency

One line for each: the date on the letter or the day of the call, who it came from, and what it says in its own words. Leave out what you think it means.

FOR EXAMPLE Letter dated the 12th, from the county office. The heading reads “Request for Information.” Karen has the original.

What has been asked for, and what is still open

Each thing that was asked for, any reply date printed in the letter, copied exactly, who is handling it, and whether it has gone back. If no date is printed, write “no date shown” and ask.

FOR EXAMPLE Asked for by phone on Monday: a copy of the pension award letter. No date shown. David is requesting the letter. Not sent yet.

Records we're still looking for

Anything for the file that hasn't turned up: identity or residency papers, income records, account statements, property papers, insurance, care information. Add where you've looked.

FOR EXAMPLE The life insurance policy. Not in Mom's desk or in the box at David's. Karen is calling the company.

What I'm not sure about, and who I'll ask

Anything on this page you don't understand, with the person it goes to: your Medicaid planner, the applications specialist, the Medicaid agency, or an elder law attorney.

FOR EXAMPLE The letter uses a word I don't know. Taking it to our next call and asking.

What this shows you

Three things: what has gone in, what has come back, and what is still open or unclear. It doesn't show whether the application is complete, what a letter means, or when a reply is due beyond the date the letter itself prints. It isn't the application file, and nothing here adds up to a score or a result. Rules vary by state, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice; those questions go to your Medicaid planner.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down what has been sent, what has been asked for and what you're still not sure about. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about the rest of your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring, with this worksheet, to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›